

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. But wait a minute- it's 2017 and you have a perfectly good digital camera on your smart phone, so you fish it out and take a bunch of pictures, just in case for your media friends.
2. Now you look at the view again — yes, it's still there; not much has changed since five minutes ago.
3. It's been an hour of steady climbing, but the view, as usual, makes up for the pain in your seldom-challenged calves and your sweat-soaked T-shirt.
4. You breathe the clean air and take in your surroundings, committing the panorama to memory.
5. Within another a minute, the view in front of your eyes is now visible to your friends on social media and pat comes the reply' you are on vacation, you better don't visit Facebook!'

Solution:

The paragraph is about a trek on a mountain and the reactions of the climber after reaching the top. The right starter would be Statement 3 which describes the feeling after an hour-long climb and how the view on the top more than makes up for the sweat and pain. Statement 4 follows describing the panoramic view and how it imprints itself in the memory. Statement 2 follows with that typical feeling- whether the view is real or imagined-with a self placating feeling "yes it is very much real." Statement 1 follows with the sudden realization that the digital camera in the cell phone can capture the panorama. Statement 5 is a sort of anti climax for the author who is on vacation and the perfect summing up of the passage.

Ans : (34215)

1. The biggest advantage for opting for a certification is that hotels have to maintain a basic energy line.
2. India's hospitality sector has kick started the International Year of Sustainable Tourism for Development with out-of-the-box initiatives that go beyond the standard rainwater harvesting and waste recycling.
3. We now have hotels sourcing solar and wind power and opting for climate responsive designs, along with more distinct features: programmable mattresses and customized temperature controls.
4. If your idea of a 'green' vacation is sleeping on organic bed linen, using recycled stationery and eating veggies grown organically in your resort's garden, 2017 has a lot more in store.
5. Certified 'green' many hotels are ensuring that the carbon footprint of the property and each guest is reduced drastically.

Solution:

The paragraph talks about a 'green' vacation. Statement 4 has a good start when it says 2017 has a lot in store for a person on the lookout for a *green* vacation. Statement 2 follows with who has made these '*out of the usual things*' for a green vacation. Statement 3 follows with what these *green* hotels have to offer. Statement 5 come next detailing how these *green* hotels strive to give you a cleaner, greener and healthier vacation. Statement 1 talks about the standards to be maintained after obtaining a *green* certificate summing up the paragraph.

Ans : (42351)

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

- ¹. "Walking is boring," said a friend, "I always listen to songs when I go for a walk in the park."
- ². That set me thinking — I realized many people have just forgotten to walk.
- ³. Treat the earth well: we do not inherit the earth from our ancestors, we borrow it from our children — Native American saying
- ⁴. They go for 'walking' for fitness, or to lose weight, or to keep their diabetes under control, or whatever.
- ⁵. But they have forgotten to walk, you know, to just go from one place to another, or to go for a walk just to take in the surroundings, going to shops and temples, visiting friends and relatives in the neighborhood, walking to the bus stop and railway station.

Solution:

The paragraph is about that forgotten activity called '*walking*'. Statement 3 is a good starter with a native American quote about the earth. Statement 1 follows with the author's friend saying that 'walking is boring'. Statement 2 follows with the author contemplating how people have forgotten to *walk*. Statement 4 follows with the author lamenting that now the act of walking has a lot of strings attached to it, like fitness, diabetes and obesity. Statement 5 sums up saying that people have stopped walking for normal things in life.

Ans : (31245)

Directions for questions 4 to 7: The following questions have a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

Research by one of us, Amy Cuddy, and colleagues Susan Fiske, of Princeton, and Peter Glick, of Lawrence University, shows that people judged to be competent but lacking in warmth often elicit envy in others, an emotion involving both respect and resentment that cuts both ways. When we respect someone, we want to affiliate ourselves with him, but resentment can make that person vulnerable to harsh reprisal. On the other hand, people judged as warm but incompetent tend to elicit pity, which also involves a mix of emotions:

- ☐ a) Compassion moves us to help those we pity, but our lack of respect leads us ultimately to neglect them.
- ☐ b) Compassion makes us trust them, but we undermine their capabilities.
- ☒ c) People consistently pick up on warmth faster than on competence. (Your answer - ✖)
- ☐ d) Warmth contributes significantly more to others' evaluations of us than competence does.

Solution:

The logical conclusion to the line of argument is that people who are warm but incompetent evoke pity and neglect for them as stated in Choice 1. Choice 2 is a distortion of the idea in the penultimate sentence - compassion cannot be the ground to develop trust and moreover, it is absurd to suggest undermining the capabilities of the people we trust. Choice 3 is an unrelated point – people picking up on warmth or competence doesn't relate to emotions. Option D is a deviation from the main point as 'evaluation' is not the issue here.
Choice (A)

Directions for questions 4 to 7: The following questions have a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

I once saw my eldest daughter teaching my youngest daughter a clapping song – "Miss Mary Mack, Mack, Mack / All dressed in black, black, black / With silver buttons, buttons, buttons / All down her back, back, back." This song was taught by my wife to my eldest child. My wife, presumably, was taught it either by her own mother or by her school friends. This rhyme, I later discovered, stretches back to the American civil war.

- ☐ a) Many of the games employed by children 50 years ago pre-existed them for many years – and many of them continue till now.
- ☐ b) We should be aware that we are imposing our cultural values on a venerable system of codes and signals.
- ☐ c) I was surprised by the depth and range of these childhood games.

☒ d) It then struck me that childhood is not only a situation in time, but a whole culture, a historical dynamic.
(Your answer - ✓)

Solution:

Going by the argument in the passage, option D, which refers to childhood as not only a situation of time, but a whole culture and a historical dynamic, is more comprehensive a conclusion than option A which limits the background of the songs to 50 years and more. Option B is unrelated to the context and option C is very shallow.
Choice (D)

Directions for questions 4 to 7: The following questions have a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

Rushdie moved to London as a schoolboy, studied at Cambridge and has lived most of his life in the west. Jhumpa Lahiri too has lived her life in the U.S. with brief visits back to India. She knows how to weave plot and character with great subtlety; she has a way of understanding the psychological agony that people suffer in certain social conditions. She is a remarkable observer of human interaction and of how relationships are made, and she has a very finely tuned sense of place in her work.

☒ a) This is why she's a great writer, not because her parents happen to be Indian. (Your answer - ✓)

- ☐ b) We Indians revel in her success, no matter where she lives.
- ☐ c) Indians and Indian-Americans are quite thrilled with Lahiri's meteoric rise.
- ☐ d) In spite of her talent and luck, she is, in many ways, just like her readers.

An established social role for the authority-granted to the military by virtue of its role in defending the State-facilitates its acceptance. Overarching justification is usually provided by the State rather than the military itself. Depending on the situation, this justification may be clear and concrete: for example, the need to defend territory, citizens, or citizens of allied powers. If concrete justifications cannot be found, more abstract ones, citing threats to freedoms, values, or 'our way of life', will be employed. When justifications are liable to be challenged that is, when the authority of the politicians who defend them is not necessarily accepted the more concrete they are the better. _____.

- ☐ a) Knowing that actions are required and approved of by the State can help to increase obedience and reduce the stress associated with carrying out those actions.

☒ b) When political authority is strong, ethereal ideas suffice. (Your answer - ✓)

- ☐ c) To achieve this, the military emphasizes the importance of obedience to authority.
- ☐ d) As Stanley Milgram's experiments showed, persuading even highly socialized, liberal, and otherwise gentle people to harm others for a cause is frighteningly easy if the instructing authority is accepted.

Directions for questions 8 to 10: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and mark the letter corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

India has a proud history of regional primacy, a deep resentment at its long colonial subjugation to a European power, and a belief in its impending greatness on the world stage. The sense of its own greatness is not new, but it has changed with the times. In the years after independence, India conceived of itself not as a great traditional power but as a great moral counterweight to the imperial powers and superpowers of the twentieth century. India's leaders expressed contempt for "power politics" and saw their nation's emergence on the world scene "as the harbinger of a new set of principles of peaceful coexistence and multilateralism which if applied properly would transform the world".

1. India, which has a proud history, is resentful of the British rule and its greatness on the world stage; it has high moral values which could ultimately transform the world.
2. India has an illustrious history of political morality through which it counter-balances other superpowers in the world and brings about a moral change within all other countries.
3. India has come out of its geopolitical shell, counter-balancing the world's superpowers with its political morality and many-sided principles of peaceful co-existence which could change the world.
4. India is a nation of flesh and blood, with all the passions, resentments, and ambitions of the human soul which will ultimately lead to a change and betterment of the world.

Solution:

The paragraph says: India takes pride in its greatness and has changed with time challenging/counter-balancing world's superpowers – thus coming out of its geopolitical shell. The paragraph further adds that Indian leaders are the harbingers (introducers) of a new set of principles, which are many-sided, with respect to a peaceful coexistence among nations. All these points are covered in option 3. Option 1 suggests that India is resentful of the greatness of the British rule, which is inapt. Option 2 says 'other superpowers' which suggests that it is one of the superpowers, which is out of context. Option 4 is a generalized statement that does not capture the idea of India changing over a period of time, in order to be able to affect the other nations through its ideas. Hence option 3 is the apt gist of the paragraph.

Ans : (3)

Directions for questions 8 to 10: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and mark the letter corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

We have so strongly emphasized the rights of individuals and the need for individualism and self-realization, that the sense of commitment to another, the sense of bonding and of reaching out to meet the needs of the other is scarcely there.

1. We rarely reach out to others now a days as we have a right to be individualistic and self-centered.
2. Commitment and bonding have become rare commodities due to emphasis on individualism and self-realization.
3. Individualism and self-realization have eroded the sense of bonding and empathy among individuals.
4. Individualism and self-realization have assumed gigantic proportions and people hardly have the time to stop and stare.

Solution:

The main points here are:

1. Negative aspects- individualism and self- realization.
2. Positive aspects- bonding and reaching out to others in the hour of need or empathy.

Choice 3 covers all these points and is the right answer. Choice 1 takes a tone of justifying the negative aspects and hence rejected. Choice 2 is elaborate and leaves out the vital aspect of empathy and hence rejected. Choice 4 takes a poetic tone leaving out the vital points and hence it is ignored.

Ans : (3)

But when the government says not only that you must be twenty-one years of age, a resident of the community and a native born or naturalized, those are qualifications, but when it says that an elector must be a male, that is not a qualification for citizenship; that is an insurmountable barrier between half of the people and the other half, and no government which erects an insurmountable barrier between one half of the citizens and their rights as citizens can call itself a republic.

1. In a republican government, qualifications for voting are different from the qualifications for getting elected.
2. A government can be called a republic in the true sense only when the gender-bias is completely eradicated from the system.
3. The merging of the thin line between qualifications for voting and qualities for getting elected form the basis of a republican government.
4. A government cannot be called a republican one if it has different yard sticks for the electorate and the elected.

Solution:

The main points here are:
1. The characteristics of a true republican government.
2. Gender- bias.
These two points are beautifully covered in Choice 2 which is the right answer. Choices 1 and 3 are only partly true and hence rejected. Choice 4 is vague and hence rejected.
Ans : (2)

Directions for questions 11 and 12: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. Fishing is the principal livelihood for over 200 million people and provides the main source of protein for more than a billion.
2. Over exploitation of fish and other resources, destructive fishing, unregulated development, pollution and climate change are altering oceans in numerous ways.
3. Humans rely on the oceans for their important natural resources.
4. Oceans contain the greatest diversity of life on Earth.
5. From the freezing polar regions to the warm waters of the tropics and deep sea hydro-thermal vents to shallow sea-grass beds, marine organisms abound.

Solution:

The paragraph is about oceans, marine life and how humans are dependent on the oceans for their natural resources. The starter would be statement 4 which talks about oceans containing a diversity of life. Next comes statement 5 talking about the vast regions covered by the marine organisms. Statement 3 follows saying how humans rely on the ocean for natural resources. Statement 1 elaborates these natural resources which offer livelihood to humans. Statement 2 sums up lamenting that various destructive activities are altering the oceans in numerous ways. Thus, 45312 is the logical order of the sentences.

Ans : (45312)

Directions for questions 11 and 12: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and mark the correct sequence in the box provided below each question.

1. African countries lose approximately \$25 million annually in tourism revenue due to current levels of elephant poaching as tourists come from all over the world to see the animals.
2. There are strong moral and ethical arguments for conserving elephants, but investing in elephant conservation is a good economic decision, too.
3. Industrial projects have made it easier for poachers to access the park and to traffic illegal ivory.
4. Almost 110,000 elephants used to roam the reserve, but only 15,000 elephants remain.
5. Rampant ivory poaching has reduced the elephant population in Selous by 90% in less than 40 years.

Solution:

The paragraph is about elephants and ivory poaching in Selous. Statement 5 starts on a somber note by talking about rampant ivory poaching reducing the elephant population in Selous by 90 percent over the past 40 years. Statement 4 follows, with the depressing news that out of the 110,000 elephants only 15,000 remain. Statement 3 comes next with the reason for this sad state of affairs. Statement 2 follows, saying that apart from the moral and ethical grounds for conserving elephants, investing in elephant conservation is good for the economy too. Statement 1 sums up highlighting the economic aspect of elephant conservation. Thus, 54321 is the logical sequence of the options.

Ans : (54321)

Directions for questions 13 to 15: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. China has proclaimed itself as militarily and technologically superior to India.
2. China has ramped up its space program since its first manned spaceflight in 2003.
3. The European Space Agency, or ESA, has described its "Moon Village" as a potential international launching pad for future missions to Mars.
4. Further details on what the collaboration could entail were not revealed.
5. China is engaged in talks with the European Space Agency about collaborating on a human outpost on the moon.

Solution:

The paragraph talks about the enhanced efforts of China in Space. The perfect starter would be Statement 5 which states that China is in talks with the European Space Agency about collaborating on a human outpost on the moon. Next would be Statement 4 which states that further details on this collaboration are not known. Statement 3 follows, with the real reason for the Chinese interest for the collaboration- a ready-made 'Moon Village' which can be a potential international launching pad for future missions to Mars. Statement 2 sums up saying that China has increased its emphasis on space programs since its first unmanned spaceflight in 2003. Thus, 5432 forms a logical sequence of sentences and Statement 1, which talks about China's military and technology superiority, is the odd one out.

Ans : (1)

Directions for questions 13 to 15: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. On the upside there is evidence that both governments are now doing more stringent monitoring but on the downside this seems to be just driving many farmers to burn the stubble covertly.
2. What's needed is the political resolve to deliver these solutions.
3. Once again the Environment Pollution Control Authority has directed both state governments to ensure that there is no wheat stubble burning.
4. In a week or so wheat harvesting will end in Punjab and Haryana and it will be time to get the fields ready for paddy planting in the monsoon.
5. This is a very worrying time because, if farmers ready their fields by burning stubble, the dark smoke clouds bring in their wake severe air pollution.

Solution:

The paragraph speaks about one of the major causes of global warming – fossil burning. The right starter would be statement 4 which speaks about the end of harvesting season in Punjab and Haryana and how the fields have to be readied for paddy planting in the ensuing monsoon. Statement 5 follows, lamenting about how it is a worrying time with farmers readying their fields by fossil burning leading to severe air pollution. Statement 3 follows, with the Environment Pollution Control Authority already having directed both the state governments to ensure there is no stubble burning. Statement 1 sums up saying that in spite of the monitoring, farmers continue to burn stubble covertly. Thus, 4531 forms a logical sequence of sentences and Statement 2 which talks delivering of solutions may only be later in the passage making it the odd one out.

Ans : (2)

Directions for questions 13 to 15: Each of the following questions presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick a statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

1. This includes cutting staff strength, slowing down new hiring, initiating mass re-training programs.
2. Faced with a tightening visa regime in the US and increasing industry-wide automation, top IT companies are taking drastic measures.
3. India's blue chip IT sector is experiencing rough weather.
4. The first step towards this would be dismantling the oppressive license raj that still exists in this sector even as it has become history in India's product markets.
5. All of this comes on the heels of a McKinsey report that almost half of India's 37 lakh IT services workforce will become irrelevant over the next three to four years.

Solution:

The paragraph talks about the blue chip IT sector of India. Statement 3 would be the ideal starter when it says that the IT sector is facing an unfavorable climate around the globe. Statement 2 follows, with the reasons for this rough weather and the drastic measures being taken by the IT companies. Statement 1 comes next briefing about these drastic measures like flab shedding, less hiring and mass re-training. Statement 5 sums up saying that the main basis of these drastic measures is the McKinsey report which says that majority of the IT services work force would be irrelevant over the next four years. Thus, 3215 forms a logical sequence of the sentences and Statement 4 which talks about the oppressive license raj seems to be the odd one out.

Ans : (4)

Directions for questions 16 and 17: In each of the following questions, the word at the top is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

BILL

☒ a) The **bill** for \$1000 which I received in the mail this morning, left me feeling perplexed. (Your answer - ✖)

☐ b) The **bill** proved to be a useful weapon in the Middle Ages.

☐ c) Upon paying the amount, the cashier handed me a **bill**. (Correct Answer - ✔)

☐ d) The bird's long **bill**, helped it to snatch its prey with ease.

Solution:

The usage of the word bill, given in Choice C, is not correct. A bill is a printed or written statement of the money owed for goods or services. 'Thus, upon paying cash, one would be given a 'receipt' and not a 'bill'

Choices (C)

Directions for questions 16 and 17: In each of the following questions, the word at the top is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

HEEL

☒ a) The strong winds caused the ship to **heel**. (Your answer - ✖)

☐ b) The little girl was in the **heels** of her mother. (Correct Answer - ✔)

☐ c) After walking barefoot on the hot sand, my **heels** began to hurt.

☐ d) Upon seeing the dog approach her, Sara took to her **heels**.

Solution:

In Choice B, the correct phrase is 'at the heels' and not 'in the heels'

Choices (B)

18. **Directions for question 18:** In the following question, there are four sentences. Each sentence has pairs of words/phrases that are italicized and highlighted. From the italicized and highlighted word(s)/phrase(s), select the **most appropriate** word(s)/phrase(s) to form correct sentences. Then, from the options given, choose the best one.

John inherited a legacy of nearly 50 crores from his **adopted** (a)/ **adoptive** (b) parents.

Interneine quarrels among the various groups do not **augur** (a)/**auger** (b) well for the integrity of the nation.

He was strongly **censored** (a)/**censured** (b) for revealing trade secrets to the rival group.

Sumit's explanation for not completing the work on time was anything but **credible** (a)/**credulous** (b).

☐ a) aaaa

☐ b) baba (Correct Answer - ✓)

☒ c) bbba (Your answer - ✗)

☐ d) baaa

Solution:

The word 'adoptive' is most suitable in the given context. An adoptive parent or family is one that has legally adopted a child. Hence b.
An auger is a tool for making holes in wood. To augur is to be a sign that something will be successful or not successful in the future. Only a is apt in this sentence.
Censor is to remove part of a book/movie etc. that are considered to be offensive or immoral. Censure is to criticize somebody severely. Hence b.
Credible refers to something that can be believed or trusted. Credulous means too ready to believe things and therefore easy to trick. Only Choice A is apt in this sentence. Therefore the correct sequence is baba. Choice (B)

Q19



Directions for questions 19 and 20 : There are two blanks in each of the following sentences.

From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

When the brains of several American footballers who died early showed signs of chronic traumatic encephalopathy, a degenerative disease also known as “boxer’s dementia”, the league dismissed the findings and _____ its own _____ research.

- ☒ a) spouted . . . doctored (Your answer - ✕)
- ☐ b) flouted . . . damning
- ☐ c) touted . . . reassuring
- ☐ d) floated . . . prevaricating

Solution:

If the football league has dismissed inculcating findings, it can only support its own agenda that the show must go on by presenting evidence to the contrary - that occupational hazards are not responsible for the early deaths of footballers. It can sell its own research which soothes the footballers' fears. Research that is doctored or prevaricating would hardly be termed as research, even though research can support an engineered hypothesis. Damning goes against the grain of reasoning in the passage. Tout is apt for the first blank as it means attempt to sell something, typically by a persistent approach.
Choice (C)

Directions for questions 19 and 20 : There are two blanks in each of the following sentences.

From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

From their _____ in the hills around Kandahar, the rebels launched a blitz on government convoys and, in the space of a few minutes, _____ heavy casualties.

☐ a) buttresses . . . claimed

☒ b) redoubts . . . caused (Your answer - ✓)

☐ c) mainstays . . . levied

☐ d) bastions . . . extracted

Solution:

Upon reading the sentence, we infer that the 1st blank is to be filled by a synonym of 'stronghold'. 'Mainstays' meaning, 'supports', is contextually inappropriate, so option C can be eliminated. Since the remaining options for the 1st blank are contextually appropriate, let us attempt to fill the 2nd blank. The blank is best filled by 'caused', 'Extracted', meaning, 'pulled out' or 'drew out', is contextually inappropriate. The 1st blank is, therefore, filled by 'redoubts', meaning, 'strongholds', and the answer option is B. Choice (B)